Dutch Treat

By Martha Kind De Silva

INTRODUCTION

Chivalry is dead. It's true, really, I mean, I can admit it. The only reason guys do nice things anymore is for the….uh…..physical benefits. Don't get me wrong, I respect women. I respect them for their ability to control men. But man, am I fed up with all this give and no receive. A dinner here flowers and chocolates there- to apologize for food poisoning at dinner- it adds up. To hell with chivalry, I'm ready for a "Dutch Treat" by Martha Kind De Silva.

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(Emmett is seated at a table in a restaurant with his date.)

EMMETT: Shall we get the check? *(He looks to the waiter)* When you're ready, we'll take the check. *(He reaches over to grab the hand of his date.)* Geez. Our six month anniversary, huh? It's hard to believe. Where does the time go, you know? It's funny. *(He sips his drink.)* When you get to that point, it's not just dates anymore. *(He nods.)* Right. It's a relationship. *(He bites his lip.)* I mean I'm not seeing anybody else and you're not seeing anybody else. *(He sips his drink again.)* And, frankly, I start thinking about what I'm getting out of the 'relationship' versus what I'm putting into it. Well, I don't mean it exactly that way, of course. God, that sounds horrible. *(Pause.)* But lately, Barbara, well, I've been thinking. And what I've been thinking is that I'm putting much, much more into this 'relationship' than what I'm getting out of it. And, well, frankly, if we're going to go on with the relationship, and that's something I want, well, I think some things need to change. Oh, no honey. It's nothing that can't be fixed. I've just been mulling over things that I might change, if I could change them and.

Okay. Here's what I mean. *(He puts his briefcase on the table.)* I came across all these receipts the other day and it hit me. Hang on a sec and you'll see what I'm talking about. *(He pulls out a stack of papers.)* I put together a spreadsheet of our relationship. Now before you get all. Just have a look. Here's where I started from. Column A is a list of the dates that we've gone on and what they have cost. Let's start with October 3rd, our first date. I thoroughly enjoyed that by the way. We went to the movies and then out for coffee afterward. It was $7.50 apiece for the movie; $5.50 for your Kahlua and Coffee; $4.75 for my Nutty Irishman. I have the receipts here if you want to check. Okay. The total which I paid for on that date was $25.25. That's not including the gas and depreciation on my car. Okay. The total which you paid on that date was O. All right, It's a first date. Kind of what I expected. And we had a nice time. Now if you look closely, you'll see that Column A-my column-continues to be full of numbers throughout the relationship. The dinner at L' Auberge Chez Francois, the weekend at the beach, the sailing trip in Annapolis. In fact, when you consider the total it's quite astounding. I had no idea I had spent so much. $2,242. Wow. Over six months. That comes out to... *(He pulls out a calculator)* over $373 per month. That's a lot of cash. All right. Let's go to your column-Column B. $24 in column B for the night that you had me over for dinner. If I'm underestimating the dinner, I'm happy to be corrected on this point. But as I recall it was a meatloaf, some potatoes, and a bottle of wine. $24 is probably about right. $24 over six months. That means you spent, well, $4 a month on me since the relationship began. *[She begins to object.]* Now just wait a minute. Let's have a look at column

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C. I've put checks in Column C on the number of times that there was sex associated with the date. Okay. This is very important, I think. Let's go back to the first date. $25.25. Movies and coffee. No sex. That's fine. I didn't expect it, really. It was a first date. *[She gets angry]* No, no, you're absolutely right. There was no discussion of sex at all. It was a kiss at your front door. Let's move down Column A a bit-my column-and see what happens. Date number two on October 11th, total for the date $47.61, no sex. Date number three on October 15th, total for the date $38.97, still no sex, what's this note I made, ah, some heavy petting, 3rd base. Ah-hah! Date number four. Dinner at Filomena's, $101.33. Sex. All right. But here's the point. I spent $213 .16 before we even had sex once. And, well, I think that's, well, that's not insignificant to me. Now let's compare Column C with Column A and I think you'll see what I'm getting at. With the exception of the meatloaf on December 2nd, Column A-my column-is completely full. But Column C is not so full. I know. We don't have to have sex every time we have a date. On January 3rd you lost your job and were upset, and of course I didn't expect you to have sex. February 19th is another case. It was the weekend we visited your parents. We talked about it and that counts for something, but we didn't actually do it because you felt uncomfortable having sex in your parents' house. Now I think I could have found a way to sneak into your bedroom to have sex with you quietly without your parents ever knowing but I didn't. I respected your wishes. There are a number of occasions here, however, when it seems as though we could have had sex and we didn't and we didn't because *you* didn't want to. What complicates this even more is Column D. Column D relates directly

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to Column C. And it's more or less my evaluation of, well, how good the sex was. Would you please sit down a minute and listen? Let's go back to date number four. Dinner at Filomena's. The dinner that I paid for that cost $101.33. A great dinner. And it was the first time we had sex. But, truth be told, the sex was not outstanding. And I think you'd agree with me on this. You had a little too much to drink, I think, and on a scale of one to five, with five being out of this world, it got a two. A sex score of two for a dinner costing $101.33 at Filomena's. All right. So, here's the deal. I am perfectly happy for Column A-my column-to continue as before. And I'm perfectly happy as well for Column B-your column-to continue as before. If that's the case, however, we have to talk about substantive, meaningful changes to Column C. And we've got to take a long look at Column D. Lots of twos and threes in Column D and frankly, I'd like for that to change as well. I don't think it's too much to ask for a couple fours and maybe a five once in a while. Now I could get ridiculous with this thing and add another column-Column E. Opportunity costs for me. Women that I could be having sex with but am not because I'm dating you. But that would be absurd. I know that. And, if you would let me finish, please don't interrupt me Barbara, of course, What I also haven't included on this spreadsheet are the-uh, the intangibles. The non-quantifiabies. The sort of psychic rewards to the relationship. And there are some. It's great not having to worry about what to do on a Friday night. You're a good listener. And when people ask me If I have a girlfriend, well, it's pretty terrific to say that, yes, I, Emmett Jones, have a girlfriend. But do those psychic rewards equal $2,2427 I don't think so. The point is not to point fingers at what's wrong

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with the relationship and who's responsible. Though I think the evidence shows, that you are probably more responsible than I. The point IS. *[She interrupts.]* Sure we can talk about Column B, but actually, Barbara, I'm more concerned with Column-What do you mean your expenses? *(He indulges her)* Like what? *(He listens.)* Your prescription for? Ortho-what? I don't know what that is. *[She shouts the answer}* Oh, *that.* Oh. *(He is embarrassed; under his breath.)* I agree. I don't want to take any chances either. Better safe than. *(He speaks sotto voce.)* How often do you have to get that filled? And how much does it cost? *(He yells.)* FOR THOSE TINY PILLS? *[She says something else.}* $100 for waxing. Waxing? Oh, they were very smooth. Yes, of course. It's just that. *(Meekly)* You don't think you could have used a razor for that? Okay, okay. A $200 bill from Victoria's Secret? For that flimsy black thing? The one with the? No, I just meant. . . What else? All right. $60. A French manicure. *(He sighs.) $148.* Cocktail dress at Ann Taylor. $37. In quarters. Washing your sheets.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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